

in between long blades of grass | in the long grass | the long grass

- i like the violence of the word blade - looking into the long grass is painful, it guards what's inside of it (story idea?)
- film/music project
- indeterminate, generative film and soundtrack

film section

- shots of trees and greenery and water in the summer
in particular deciduous trees
long grass blowing in the breeze ('the long grass' idiom)
some emphasis on willows - may also represent guanyin
- in particular of leaves rustling, fluttering in the wind
- shot around hertford and the lea river valley
- in the evening, around golden hour
- thematically about the emptiness of all phenomena
- absence of self-essence and interdependent origination
- on one level about impermanence and duhkha - the feeling of longing the images, senses, times and places create
on another level about the peace, love and compassion that arise from awareness and direct experience of the deeper natures of phenomena. especially when applied to oneself (shown by the absence of characters, narrative, self in the film?)
- long still shots of different trees, etc
- perhaps a few shots of each subject from different angles for variety and dimension
- shots edited together using indeterminacy
possibly determine from several overarching structures to map chance onto
- each screening of the film is unique - reflecting impermanence

- shots could be edited together by fading between each other, overlapping/layering and possibly shrinking and putting at just one small part of the screen (so many can exist side by side (against a black background or possibly another piece footage?))
- they could be arranged using an l-system (branching into smaller parts of the screen and overlapping as dynamic increase)
- possible text accompaniment:
generate alliterative nonsense from middle english - using words relating to nature and an emphasis on particular fricative sounds to mimic wind?
emptiness of meaning, duhkha - clinging to the past and longing? (simultaneous layers)
also aesthetic preference
- may also feature excerpts from the diamond sutra to give a clear idea about emptiness and bodhisattvas
 - treat with respect (don't cut up/obscure meaning too much)
 - perhaps open or close with passages from it
 - or accompany with physical copies/printings alongside the film for the audience
maybe part of the film description?

sound, music

- arranged from 3 indeterminate compositional sections
 - l-system - arrangement and layering of field recordings (branching out and overlapping like tree branches or blades and seeds of grass stalks)
 - fractal melody - arrangement of layers of self similar question and answer phrases of generated melodies (transforming from a start one to an end one?)
 - flexible just tuning
 - using hemitonic ionian and/or mixolydian scales
 - prayer to guanyin pusa - undulating, droning ambient piece with the warm qualities of a major 3rd (possible major 2nd/9th and 6th?)
using just intonation

- these 3 sections can stand alone but also fit together to create a complete composition
- Each section's prominence in the full composition can be variable and determined by chance
- There may be several proportional ratio structures to be determined from that decide the prominence of a particular section.
e.g. one version of the film may have a soundtrack that features an arrangement focused on 'prayer to guanyin pusa'.
such an arrangement may feature the l-system and fractal melody sections but arranged more sparsely, lower in the mix, produced to sound more distant or panned widely.
- Different combinations of the sections may vary across time in one version as well.
e.g. it may begin with a skew towards l-system, but evolve to end featuring 'prayer to guanyin pusa' more prominently.
these changes may also follow a map of dynamic change as well

combining film and sound

- Both could be mapped to an overarching dynamic structure so they evolve similarly across their duration
However one could have an increase in dynamics while another decreases and so on - to create more variety and unexpected interactions
There could also be wiggle room in the chance operations to allow unexpected interactions - meaning they are not too closely tethered together.

concepts/statements

- centrally the artwork is a prayer/meditation on emptiness and love.

the thing being kicked into the long grass is dealing with our own insecurities and thus egos and self-centeredness.

inspecting such things, which are pushed into the unconscious mind, in particular through buddhist practice, can lead to a lessening of attachment to them. This in turn can create a foundation to more deeply explore the nature of perception and reality, it can also give rise to love, compassion and selflessness.

possible l-system to use

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1hcCpLQwI-c>

X F + - []

X -> F[+X][-X]FX

F -> FF

- introduce randomisation (shown in video)

l-system ideas

- use 3 separate l-systems
 - first 2D (x and y axis), lower no. of iterations, used for l-system field recording arrangement - panning and duration/volume
 - second 3D, lower no. of iterations, used for arranging film footage- (effectively looking along the stalk of the plant from the bottom) z axis: duration, size on screen, transparency; z and y: coordinate position on the screen
 - third 3D, higher no. of iterations, for compassion prayer ambient music - same orientation as second l-system - z axis: duration - x axis: panning - y axis: pitch, timbre?
- because of the element of time - generating these pieces by moving along the l-system model in time - effectively a 4D artwork released in 3D?
the full pieces exist on generation, but can't be experienced as a whole from the pov of a 3D being

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possible names:

- bright summer in the long grass
- summer ends in the long grass
- summer's end in the long grass
- green summers for the long grass

use footage from small handheld camera

- zoom in, maybe sometimes to the point of abstraction, so there are many different shots to use and arrange these

possibly add indeterminate poetry

- using middle english, reconstructed north sea germanic?
- no grammar built out of categories of vocabulary determined in creation

possible accompanying performance for the final version for degree show/other exhibits

- noise music improvised to an indeterminately generated graphic score
- focusing on the intoxicating feeling of transitioning from quite/order to noise/chaos
- layers of noise - maybe using MG10XU no input and feedback loops of field recordings
- concept/name: Someday I Will No Longer Be Here
 - fear of death, existential dread - awareness of the fleeting nature of everything I do, every moment
- dark, atmospheric space
- record video and sound. direct sound output and room sound

screening:

- project the film largest,
- project the l-system tree for the current version separately and smaller (poss. show pieces progress moving along it as a sweeping line? - tree in green, line in pale pink or blue?)
- another separate projection of the score for the performance

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quadraphonic sound:

- installation version
- enable use of 3D l-systems
 - branch out in 4 directions instead of 2 - give branches Z axis values
 - L and R axis are -X and +X value, Backwards and Forwards axis and are -Z and +Z values
 - the 4 speakers represent each -X, +X, -Z, +Z (entirely in one speaker is panned 100% in that direction)
 - panning may be achieved using two numbers -1 to 1 L to R, and -1 to 1 back to front - where 0, 0 is complete centre, sound evenly balanced across all
 - the Y axis is time
- the listener is in the middle of a 3 dimensional sound scape
- due to the timed aspects of the piece determined from the beginning, the listener

is experiencing a 3D cross section of a 4D object

- the visualisation of the l-system depicts the 4D object and where the listener is within it (as a 2D intersection with a 3D object)
- for the 3D l-system, the listener can interact with it and rotate it

installation :

- projection of the film/visual
 - translucent paper leaves casting shadow on it (blown by fan?)
- quadraphonic surround sound
- projection or screen showing l-system visualisation, interactable
- possible set and seating?

visual/film:

- words:
 - use WIP lines from the anchoress
 - arrange as subtitles and/or spoken
 - if spoken, develop the anchoress island dialect to read (and spell?) in
- reflect feeling of longing for something that can't be held onto - the past or present moment itself, an ideal of what something should be, how you should feel
- longing and nostalgia for "home" or the feeling of being at home/at ease/content, even a return to childhood/youth (imagined or literal simpler time)
 - dukkha
 - possibly - finding spirituality as a comfort and resolution for this feeling
 - reference for feeling of ideal that can't be attained - temple of the golden pavillion

music/sound references:

- sawako
 - sound design, arrangement, field recordings, computing?
- masakatsu tagaki - kagayaki
 - field recordings, sound design

- laurie spiegel - the expanding universe
 - sound design, arrangement
- györgy ligeti - lux aeterna
 - harmony - close dissonances
- look for:
 - dense rhythmic arrangement - percussion music? (steve reich - also overlapping rhythms - minimalism)
 - polyrhythmic arrangement, use of irrational metre (fernyhough?)
 - overlapping melodic fragments - terry riley - in c? (also terry riley's II?)

visual/film references: ?

- layering in heidi's paintings?

25.09.25

visual ideas:

- alignment between overlaid images/footage
 - e.g. how space in one image makes room for what's in another
- new sense of space - how do the objects in one image appear in the other when overlaid
 - does this create a new space or augment one or all spaces layered together
 - which layers are more opaque/translucent/transparent
- how can these interactions be left to chance or directed intentionally?
- colour in composition/mixing
- blur, focus, etc
- effects/phenomena like komorebi or water rippling on a river bed can be replicated by layering
- layering:
 - play with sense of depth, texture (density, natural phenomena, blur, focus), space (empty, filled), light/dark, patterns, etc
- focus on atmosphere and feeling over narrative, plot and explicit conveyance of

concept

- like a more meaningful screen saver or visualisation
- sense of place?
- is there a way to give an impression of the l-system (arrangement and time)
 - x axis = x axis, z = y, y = time
- abstract footage by zooming in to the point of the subjects not being clear anymore
- use varying degrees of zoom
- crop to zoomed sections - cut outlines in organic shapes (lichen growth? - through anl-system?)

05.12.25 notes on tuning

- use zeta peak index (zpi) equivalents to edos!
 - they effectively squash and stretch the octave to optimise the consonance (JI) approximation of the steps (?)
 - the best edos appear to be closest to 1200¢ octaves